Carson Atwood

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EDUCATION

Oklahoma State University, Stillwater, OK Expected Graduation: December 2026
Master of Science | Animal Science
Focus: Broiler Chicken Welfare & Behavior
Advisor: Dr. Meaghan M. Meyer

Oklahoma State University, Stillwater, OK December 2024
Bachelor of Science | Animal Science

EXPERIENCE

Oklahoma State University, Stillwater, OK January 2025 – Present
Graduate Research Assistant

Graduate Research Assistant:

- **Quantifying social status in growing broiler chickens using Aggressive Rank Index (ARI)**
  - Analyze video footage to quantify social interactions and dominance behaviors across ranks.
  - Calculate ranks to classify individual birds by social status.
  - Manage data entry, quality control, and statistical analysis using Excel, SAS, and R Studio.
  - Train and supervise 5 undergraduate researchers to ensure inter-observer reliability in behavior observations.
- **Evaluating social status effects on environmental enrichment use and welfare in growing broiler chickens**
  - Evaluate the impact of social status on environmental enrichment usage, welfare, performance, and stress physiology in growing broiler chickens.
  - Oversee daily management and husbandry throughout the full broiler grow-out period
  - Collect and record performance outcomes weekly.
  - Collect and record welfare outcomes weekly.
  - Coordinate and perform post-mortem biological sample collection.

Graduate Teaching Assistant:

- **Poultry Science**
  - Co-instruct weekly laboratory sessions focused on applied broiler welfare, production, and management.
  - Supervise and coordinate the broiler grow-out project, ensuring proper husbandry, and welfare standards.
  - Guide students in accurate data collection and management.
  - Deliver guest lectures on core topics related to various poultry production topics.

- **Applied Animal Nutrition**
    - Develop complete course materials, including lectures, assessments, and activities to enhance student comprehension and student engagement.
    - Assist in evaluating student performance by grading assignments, quizzes, and exams.
    - Create and administer course review sessions and maintain regular office hours to support student comprehension of course material.
- **Introduction to the Animal Science Lab**
    - Independently instruct 2-3 laboratory sections each week covering foundational concepts in animal science.
    - Guide students through comparative production systems across various livestock species.
    - Implement interactive, hands-on activities to reinforce lecture material and enhance applied learning.
- **Capstone for Animal Agriculture**
    - Grade and evaluate graduating seniors' capstone research literature reviews and oral presentations.
    - Coordinate and assist with daily classroom activities, including organizing guest lectures and teaching laboratory sessions.

Gawf Farms, Eufaula, OK October 2021 – December 2024
Manager
- Oversee daily operations for a mixed-species livestock enterprise managing over 700 goats and cattle.
- Design and implement feed, breeding, and herd-health programs to improve productivity and animal well-being.
- Manage budgets, marketing, and record keeping ensuring operational efficiency and profitability.
- Supervise employees and seasonal staff, ensuring adherence to welfare and biosecurity standards.

Oklahoma State University, Stillwater, OK August 2024 – December 2024
Applied Animal Nutrition Undergraduate Teaching Assistant
- Supported course coordination and communication between the professor and students.
- Graded coursework and provided constructive feedback to enhance learning outcomes.

Oklahoma Animal Disease Diagnostic Laboratory, Stillwater, OK September 2022 – October 2023
Necropsy & Receiving Assistant
- Received and processed animal submissions for diagnostic testing, ensuring accurate chain–of–custody and sample labeling.
- Collaborated with pathologists and veterinarians to support necropsy and sample preparation.
- Organized case documentation and maintained biosecure laboratory environments.

Cattleman's Congress, Oklahoma City, OK December 2022 – January 2023
Livestock Intern
- Assisted with the coordination and facilitation of livestock and exhibitor move-in and setup.
- Maintained accurate records of class placings and managed award distribution logistics.
- Enforced biosecurity protocols to ensure safe and efficient animal movement throughout the facility.

Oklahoma Animal Disease Diagnostic Laboratory, Stillwater, OK March 2022 – November 2022
Histology Lab Technician
- Prepared, processed, and embedded tissue samples for histopathological examination.
- Assisted in slide preparation and labeling for diagnostic review.
- Maintained laboratory organization and quality control procedures for sample integrity.

TEACHING & STUDENT MENTORSHIP

Courses Assisted

Course	Role	Year	Semester	No. Students
ANSI 4863: Capstone for Animal Agriculture	Teaching Assistant	2026	Spring	115
ANSI 1021: Introduction to the Animal Science Lab	Teaching Assistant	2026	Spring	85
ANSI 4023: Poultry Science	Co-Instructor	2025	Fall	16
ANSI 1021: Introduction to the Animal Science Lab	Teaching Assistant	2025	Fall	80
ANSI 3653: Applied Animal Nutrition	Teaching Assistant	2025	Fall	143
ANSI 3651: Applied Animal Nutrition Lab	Teaching Assistant	2025	Spring	32

Guest Lectures

Course	Semester	No. Lectures
ANSI 3623: Livestock Behavior and Environmental Interaction	Spring 2026	1
ANSI 4023: Poultry Science	Fall 2025	2
ANSI 3653: Applied Animal Nutrition	Spring 2025	1
ANSI 3653: Applied Animal Nutrition Lab	Spring 2025	2

Student Mentorship (Teaching)

Student	Role	Course	Year
Maria Solis-Arana	Teaching Assistant Mentor	ANSI 1021: Introduction to the Animal Science Lab	Spring 2026
Ashlyn Eschberger	Teaching Assistant Mentor	ANSI 1021: Introduction to the Animal Science Lab	Spring 2026
Avery Beiergrohslein	Teaching Assistant Mentor	ANSI 4023: Poultry Science	Fall 2025
Kelsey Wall	Teaching Assistant Mentor	ANSI 1021: Introduction to the Animal Science Lab	Fall 2025
Kelsey Pinkerton	Teaching Assistant Mentor	ANSI 1021: Introduction to the Animal Science Lab	Fall 2025
Donovan Thomas	Teaching Assistant Mentor	ANSI 1021: Introduction to the Animal Science Lab	Fall 2025
Jacqueline Oen	Teaching Assistant Mentor	ANSI 1021: Introduction to the Animal Science Lab	Fall 2025
Payton Pohlmeier	Teaching Assistant Mentor	ANSI 3653: Applied Animal Nutrition	Spring 2025
Callie Roberts	Teaching Assistant Mentor	ANSI 3653: Applied Animal Nutrition	Spring 2025

Student Mentorship (Research)

Student	Role	Research Topic	Year
Kyra Cole	Undergraduate Research Scholar	Broiler behavior and welfare assessment	Spring 2025 – Present
Hannah West	Undergraduate Research Mentor	Broiler behavior and welfare assessment	Fall 2025 – Present
Addison Harlow	Undergraduate Research Mentor	Broiler behavior and welfare assessment	Fall 2025 – Present
Kimberly Fonseca-Torres	Undergraduate Research Mentor	Broiler behavior and welfare assessment	Spring 2026 – Present
Mary Saunders	Undergraduate Research Mentor	Broiler behavior and welfare assessment	Spring 2026 – Present

ABSTRACTS

1. **Atwood, C. D.**, J. L. Salak-Johnson, and M. M. Meyer. 2026. Quantifying social rank in growing broiler chickens using Aggressive Rank Index. World's Poultry Congress, Toronto, Canada.
2. Cole, K. G., **C. D. Atwood**, J. L. Salak-Johnson, and M. M. Meyer. 2026. The effect of social status on tonic immobility in growing broiler chickens. Oklahoma State University Undergraduate Research Symposium, Stillwater, Oklahoma.
3. **Atwood, C. D.**, J. L. Salak-Johnson, and M. M. Meyer. 2026. Social rank influences resource use and finishing growth performance in broilers. Poultry Science Association Annual Meeting, Toronto, Canada.

CERTIFICATIONS & TECHNICAL TRAINING

- Institutional Animal Care & Use Committee (IACUC) – Oklahoma State University — January 2025
- Working with Poultry in Agricultural Research Settings – Oklahoma State University — January 2025
- Working with Cattle in Agricultural Research Settings – Oklahoma State University — January 2025
- Undue Foreign Influence: Risks and Mitigations – Oklahoma State University — January 2025
- Small Ruminant Artificial Insemination – Bosque Valley Reproduction — June 2021
- Cattle Artificial Insemination & Palpation – Reproduction Enterprises Inc. — July 2020

AFFILIATIONS

- Oklahoma State Animal and Food Science Graduate Student Association, Member — 2025 – Present
- World Poultry Science Association, Member — 2025 – Present
- Poultry Science Association, Member — 2025 – Present

ENGAGEMENT & OUTREACH

- Judge, Animal Science Division – Oklahoma FFA Northeast Area Speech Contest (2024 & 2025)